Prepared for BlackRock

Aladdin Studio, learned with AI

What public sources show about Studio and the likely initial directions for marketing it

Prepared by **Jacob Nikolau** | As of October 19, 2026

Part 1
What the public record shows
Page 3

Part 2
Four findings on BlackRock's direction and the market
Page 10

Part 3
What the research suggests for this role's first six months
Page 15

Independent analysis from public sources with AI agents. Not produced, reviewed or endorsed by BlackRock.

Executive summary

Studio is the product behind the growth story BlackRock tells investors.

17x

Growth in API calls BlackRock projects by 2030, on its 2025 Investor Day slide

$25.6M

JPMorgan Chase's 2025 payments for Aladdin, per its proxy statement, almost 6x its 2017 payments

0

Mentions of Studio by a BlackRock executive on 26 earnings calls, Q1 2020 to Q2 2026

Sources, left to right: BlackRock 2025 Investor Day[1], the slide on keeping the cost of growth low. It projects API calls 17x, model portfolios 4x, portfolios 2x and trade allocations 1.3x, and does not say which products generate the API calls; attributing them to Studio is my inference. JPMorgan Chase proxy statements[2, 3]. Third-party earnings call transcripts[4].

Studio is Aladdin's developer and data layer, with three parts: APIs and events, a Python SDK and Aladdin Data Cloud on Snowflake. Four BlackRock speakers have defined it the same way since 2024[5].

API calls are the fastest-growing measure BlackRock showed investors: 17x by 2030. Buyers at BlackRock's webinar want a core platform plus their own builds, and rivals already sell to that demand[6].

Five likely initial directions:

1. Collect named client proof, starting with clients whose Aladdin relationship is already public.
2. Write the one-page definition of Studio that four speakers so far give only in recordings.
3. Prepare an RFP-ready answer to the question buyers now ask: what is your API suite?
4. Describe the Copilot plugin model publicly: API mapping, governance, how client AI tools plug in.
5. Write a one-page summary for prospects of what the public API catalog contains.

What this method can and cannot do

Public material only: BlackRock web pages, the 54 API specifications inside 11 public `asdk_plugin` Python packages, 128 recordings, SEC filings, procurement notices, GitHub and PyPI. AI agents pulled them in about a day; I checked every fact against its document. Some recordings are machine-transcribed, so names and jargon can be misheard. I have no internal product context, so some conclusions may be wrong for reasons I cannot see.

How to read the receipts

Underlined text links to the document behind the fact. Each superscript number points to an entry in Sources, at the end of this document, giving the grade (P, S or T), title, speaker and date.

■ **P** Primary document: a filing, a specification, a web page or press release, a procurement notice, or code on GitHub or PyPI

■ **S** BlackRock speaker on the record, with the name and title as the recording gives them

□ **T** Third-party report: trade press, or a third party's summary of a primary source

Part 1

What the public record shows

Aladdin is the investment platform BlackRock built for itself and sells to other institutions. Brennan Rosales, its AI Engineering Lead, put the scale this way at a LangChain conference in 2025. "BlackRock is the biggest user of Aladdin, but we also sell and support hundreds of clients globally across 70 countries." The organization is "around 7,000 people, with over 4,000 of those being engineers." They maintain "around 100 Aladdin front-end applications"[7]. BlackRock's technology services and subscription revenue was $2.0 billion in 2025, up 24 percent including Preqin, the private-markets data firm bought in 2025[8]. BlackRock sells the platform as one engine with separate entry points, and Studio is the entry point for people who write code.

Exhibit 1. Of Aladdin's eight named products, Studio is the one for people who write code

Product	What it does	Main users
Aladdin	The front-to-back system for public markets, the same system BlackRock runs internally[7]	Asset managers, insurers, pension funds, banks
Aladdin Wealth	Portfolio risk analysis and proposals for advisors. Its AI "auto commentary" tool launched in October 2025, with Morgan Stanley as the first client[9]	Wealth managers and private banks
eFront	A private-fund investment platform covering due diligence through cash flows and reporting. Preqin now sits inside eFront Insight, and private credit analytics were added on Preqin in May 2026[10]	Investors in funds and fund managers
Aladdin Studio	**The developer and data layer. It covers APIs and events, a Python SDK, Aladdin Compute and Aladdin Data Cloud. BlackRock calls it "API-first" and names three users: "a professional engineer building new workflow applications, a code-curious portfolio manager extracting investment insights, or a data analyst automating reporting"[11]**	**Client engineers, data analysts, code-curious portfolio managers**
Aladdin Data Cloud	A managed data service on Snowflake that puts Aladdin and outside data in one place. It is sold as an add-on to Aladdin Enterprise[12]. Richard Newman, General Manager, Aladdin Studio, calls it "part of Studio"[13]	Data teams
Aladdin Copilot	A chat assistant "now available to all Aladdin clients" that "will not give investment advice"[14]	All platform users
Aladdin Accounting	Investment accounting and performance. Its public APIs cover configuration, valuations, lots and composites[15]	Asset managers and asset owners
Aladdin Provider	Connects custodians and administrators to a client's Aladdin. The providers pay BlackRock to use it[16]	Custodians and administrators

Source: BlackRock product pages[11, 14, 17]; Amazon press release, December 2025[12]; iShares prospectus[16]; the public specifications[15].

BlackRock's own definition of Studio comes from the head of Studio engineering, on Snowflake's podcast in November 2025.

> "So we think about Aladdin today as a platform and Aladdin Studio is essentially the user experience that allows people to think of Aladdin as a platform. It exposes everything Aladdin knows how to do as a set of APIs events. The Aladdin data cloud built on top of Snowflake takes all of that information that's generated through our analytics factory and inside of Aladdin and pushes that into Snowflake. And increasingly we're building a set of developer tools."
>
> — Dave Woodhead, Managing Director and Head of Engineering for Aladdin Studio, Snowflake Data Cloud podcast, published November 11, 2025[5]

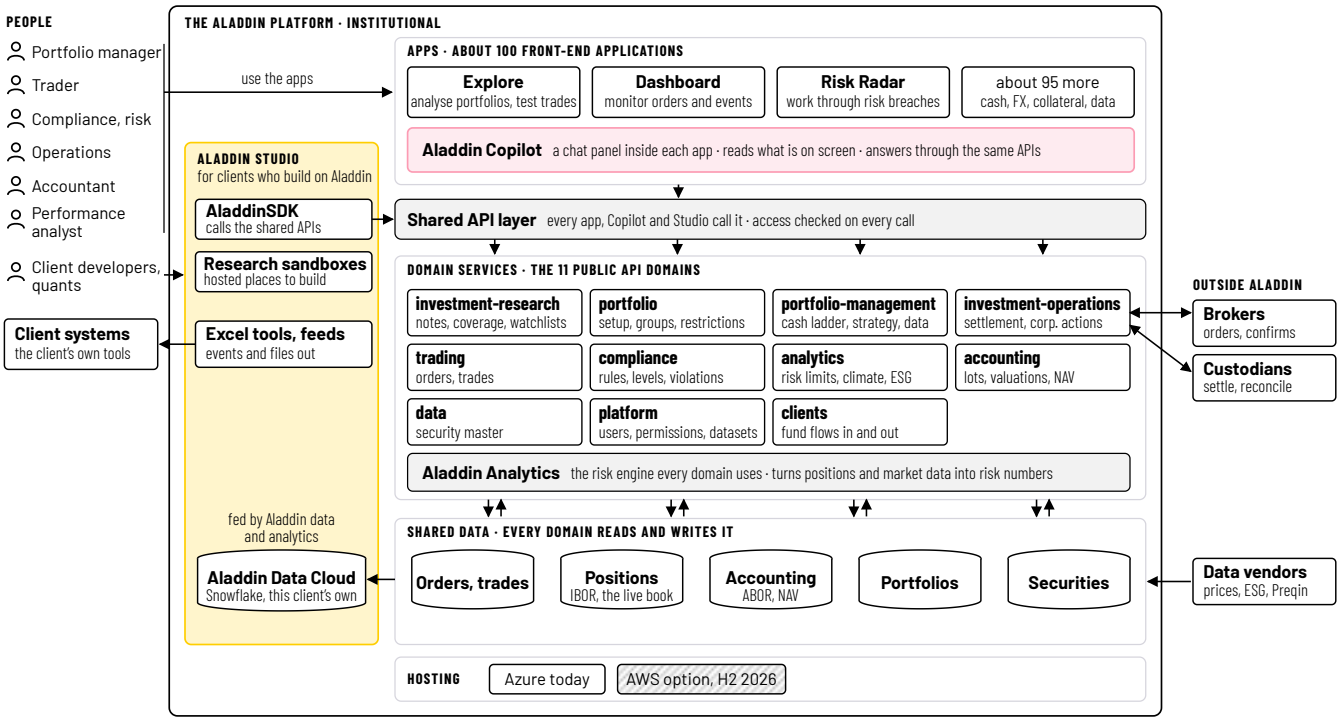
Exhibit 2 follows one trade through Aladdin, step by step, as far as the 54 public specifications describe it[15, 18].

Exhibit 2. The public APIs follow a trade from order to NAV

Step	Who acts	Product or application BlackRock names	Public API that covers it
1 **Order**	The portfolio manager. An order is "a directive from a portfolio manager to the trading desk to execute a particular investment decision" (Order spec)[15]	The Explore application: its "new what-if model" (Explore classroom recording) compares a changed portfolio with the original before anything is traded[19]	`OrderAPI` v1 (stable). Posting an order takes `whatIf` and `runCompliance`. Its example statuses run "Open," "Compl Pending," "Authorized," "Active," "Booked"[15]
2 **Compliance check**	No one. The check runs automatically when the order is posted, because `runCompliance` is on by default. Any violation then carries an owner, a disposition and a resolution comment[15]	Rules "automatically monitor whether a fund adheres to a regulation, client mandate, or internal guideline" (ComplianceRule spec); no application is named[15]	`ComplianceRuleAPI` and `ViolationAPI` v1 (alpha). Violations are "generated at time of the compliance breach" (Violation spec). A check that times out posts the order as "Compl Pending"[15]
3 **Trade**	The trading desk. Operations then confirms it, because "after a trade is booked in Aladdin, it needs to be confirmed with broker" (BrokerConfirmRouting spec)[15]	Schneid or Shannon of Aladdin Accounting describes the run as going "from that first order through the trade, through all the operation protocols into accounting without lifting up the pencil"[18]	`TradeAPI` v2 (alpha). A block trade carries its per-portfolio trades, plus `confirmedWith` and `confirmedBy`. `BrokerConfirmRoutingAPI` routes the confirm[15]
4 **Position in the IBOR**	The investment team, whose live book is the IBOR, the investment book of record. Richard Newman, Studio's general manager: "It does start with IBOR"[13]	Aladdin Data Cloud, where users "can access their Investment Books of Record (IBOR), Accounting Books of Record (ABOR) holdings" (Fivetran's blog)[20]	None of the 54 is a position API. Positions appear only as fields: a positions source in `PortfolioToolkitAPI`, and a violation's "underlying positions" (Violation spec)[15]
5 **Lot in the ABOR**	The accounting team, which says of itself: "we are data managers more than anything else" (Schneid or Shannon)[18]	Aladdin Accounting, named in the portfolio-configuration specification[15]	`AborLotAPI` v1 (alpha). ABOR lots, the accounting book of record, are "retrieved from the ledger_a_summary table" (AborLot spec)[15]
6 **NAV**	Accounting, whose clients are "CFOs, they're controllers, they're heads of performance" (Schneid or Shannon)[18]	Aladdin Accounting; each valuation carries an exception list[15]	`ValuationsAPI` v1, beta: valuations "generated for various processes at the portfolio/portfolio group level" (Valuations spec)[15]

■ Source: the public specifications named in each cell[15]; Newman[13]; the Explore training recording[19]; the Aladdin Accounting episode with David Schneid and Daniel Shannon, which does not label who is speaking[18]; Fivetran[20]. The specifications name no order screen and hold no position or event API, and they do not say in what sequence steps 4 to 6 happen. The labels in brackets are each specification's stability label: alpha is the earliest, then beta, stable and sunset; Exhibit 5 counts them.

Exhibit 3. Apps, Copilot and Studio all call one shared API layer



For illustrative purposes only. ■ Source: about 100 apps, with Copilot in all of them, Rosales and Vicente Valdez at 2:35[7]. The 11 domains behind the shared layer are the packages of BlackRock's public SDK, named as in its specifications[15, 21]. App names other than Explore come from field descriptions in those specifications, so their screens are not drawn[15, 19]. Aladdin Analytics is the name the risk specifications give the engine[15]. Studio, Woodhead at 4:49[5]; Excel tools and feeds, the APIs page[22]; Data Cloud fed by Aladdin data and analytics[5, 17]; hosting[23, 12]. Solid outline = shown in sources; hatched = announced, not live.

Exhibit 4. Six pieces make up Studio

Piece	What it is, in plain words
APIs (Aladdin Graph)	Ways for a program to read and write Aladdin data. Aladdin Graph is the whole API layer, not one API: every public specification carries an id of the form `agraph.<domain>.<segment>.<group>.v1.<API>`[15]. The APIs page says there are "dozens," with more added regularly[22]. The 54 specifications include orders, trades, compliance rules, risk rules, security creation and Data Cloud datasets[15].
Event-driven APIs	Aladdin tells a program when something happens. Woodhead names "APIs events" as one part[5]; Diwakar Goel, Global Head of Data, Aladdin, wants "every single transaction … via an event, via an API"[24]. No event specification is in the public packages[15].
Aladdin Data Cloud	A managed data store on Snowflake, with Fivetran moving the data. Goel puts its latency at "within 15 minutes"[24]. Woodhead: "hundreds of Snowflake accounts … tens of thousands of pipelines"[5].
Aladdin Compute	A hosted space where developers run Python next to their Aladdin data; the SDK has a run mode for "Aladdin Studio Compute sessions"[21].
Aladdin SDK	An open-source Python library that handles login, retries, rate limits, pagination and long-running operations[21]. Eleven add-on packages, one per API domain, are generated from the specifications by BlackRock's plugin builder[25].
Developer Portal and Data Dictionary	The API catalog, framework guides, field dictionary, notebooks and code samples the APIs page describes. All sit behind a client login[22].

■ Source: BlackRock Studio and APIs pages[11, 22]; the 54 public specifications and SDK README[15, 21]; Woodhead[5] and Goel[24]. No event specification is public[15]; the catalog, guides, notebooks and samples sit behind a client login[22].

Exhibit 5. Two domains hold 127 of the 301 public API operations

Domain	Specs	Operations	Alpha	Beta	Stable	Sunset	Largest APIs by operations
Investment operations	15	**74**	9	4	2	–	PrincipalInterestFactor, CounterPartySettlementInstruction, MiscellaneousCashflow, CouponReset and 11 more
Analytics	9	**53**	–	–	8	1	RiskRule, RiskWorkflow, RiskException, RiskConfig and 5 more
Investment research	5	**41**	5	–	–	–	AnalystCoverage, Criterion, Watchlist, ResearchNote and 1 more
Platform	6	**29**	2	–	4	–	AdcDataset, UserGroup, User, UserGroupPermission and 2 more
Portfolio management	4	**28**	1	–	3	–	CIDWriter, Strategy, CIDReader, CashLadder
Portfolio	3	**23**	1	–	2	–	PortfolioGroup, RestrictedAsset, PortfolioToolkit
Data	1	**15**	–	–	1	–	SecurityCreation
Trading	2	**14**	1	–	1	–	Order, Trade
Compliance	4	**9**	3	–	1	–	ComplianceRuleAssignment, Violation, ComplianceRule, Level
Accounting	4	**8**	2	2	–	–	PortfolioConfiguration, Valuations, CompositeMembership, AborLot
Clients	1	**7**	–	–	1	–	EnrichedCapitalFlow
Total	**54**	**301**	**24**	**6**	**23**	**1**	11 domains, 11 PyPI packages

■ Source: the 54 Swagger 2.0 specifications inside the 11 `asdk_plugin` packages, version 2.0.0b3, on PyPI[15]. Counts are mine, recomputed from the files. The core `aladdinsdk` package adds four utility APIs (token, subscription, notification and a demo), not counted here. Alpha, beta, stable and sunset are the stability labels each specification carries (its `x-aladdin-api-stability` field), alpha being the earliest; the four columns count specs by label.

Posting an order takes `whatIf` and `runCompliance`, which defaults to true, and the response returns any compliance violations inline[15]. Ten specifications expose an endpoint for long-running operations, 35 operations are flagged as long-running, and the SDK polls them[21]. Risk exceptions and Data Cloud datasets carry bitemporal fields, which record two time dimensions. Rule assignments and dataset releases name a four-eyes approval, a second sign-off[15]. Every request carries an application key plus OAuth 2.0 scopes such as `trading.order_management.order.v1.Order:read`, and the client ID and secret come from the Studio UI[21].

What is public before a conversation starts

Exhibit 6 follows a prospect's engineer through six steps, from first hearing about Studio to getting help. For each step it records what is public today and what a client receives after qualification.

The SDK's dependencies conflict with the official MCP toolkit. An outside contributor's fix for the conflict was merged in August 2026 and has not shipped[26]. The README documents three run modes: "a developer's local machine," "Aladdin Studio Compute sessions" and a test mode. It stores a prompted password in the operating system's credential manager. It carries settings for firms that consume "the Aladdin APIs via an enterprise API management platform such as Azure API Management"[21].

Exhibit 6. What I was not able to see from outside, and what opens after qualification

Step	Public today	After qualification	Receipt
Hear	Podcasts, webinar replays, client videos and conference talks on BlackRock's site and partner channels	Client forums and the solutions team	the Never Done podcast[27], the Big Little Questions video series[28], Woodhead[5], Rosales and Valdez[7]
Read	The Studio page ("Create & automate," "Make Aladdin your own," "Align internally & externally") and the APIs page, which promises "dozens of APIs"	The Developer Portal and the API framework guides	Studio page[11], APIs page[22]
See the catalog	The 54 specifications, but only by unpacking the 11 PyPI add-on packages	The API catalog and the Data Dictionary	asdk_plugin packages[15], APIs page[22]
Try	Nothing to run: no public sandbox or trial is offered	Studio Compute; an API token or an OAuth application "registered via Studio UI"; and the client's own Aladdin host to call	SDK README[21]
Build	The open-source SDK on GitHub and PyPI, with a detailed README; the plugin builder	A client host and credentials, which the SDK needs for every call	SDK README[21], PyPI history[29], plugin builder[25]
Get help	GitHub issues and pull requests on the SDK, answered by BlackRock engineers; on the Studio page, "Book a meeting" and "Download the brochure"	Notebooks, code samples, support	Pull request 52[30], pull request 57[26], Studio page[11]

■ Source: the pages and repositories in the Receipt column, read with no account or login, October 2026. The After qualification column is what those sources say a client receives; I did not test it.

Exhibit 7. Investment platforms, Studio among them, open to developers only after a relationship exists

2: Fully public or self-serve 1: Partial or after sign-up or approval 0: None or blocked

Platform	Public docs	API catalog	Trial or sandbox	First API call without a contract	Sample code	Community or marketplace	AI connector	Call to action	Total
Investment platforms									
Bloomberg	1	0	1	1	1	0	0	1	**5**
Aladdin Studio	**1**	**1**	**0**	**0**	**1**	**1**	**0**	**0**	**4**
State Street	1	0	1	0	0	1	0	1	**4**
Arcesium	0	0	0	0	0	1	2	0	**3**
SimCorp	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	0	**1**
Clearwater	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	0	**1**

Platform	Public docs	API catalog	Trial or sandbox	First API call without a contract	Sample code	Community or marketplace	AI connector	Call to action	Total
Data and cloud platforms									
Snowflake	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	**16**
Databricks	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	**16**
LSEG	1	2	1	1	2	2	2	1	**12**
FactSet	2	2	0	0	2	1	2	0	**9**
MSCI	0	0	0	0	0	0	2	0	**2**

For the AI connector score: 2 means a connector that outside AI tools can use, such as an MCP server. 1 means one announced or in limited release. 0 means none, or an assistant that works only inside the vendor's own platform.

Source: my test of each platform's public pages[11, 31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38], no accounts or payments, October 8, 2026. Bloomberg, Clearwater and MSCI may score lower than they deserve, because some of their pages blocked automated access.

Exhibit 7 puts Studio beside 10 platforms that a Studio buyer also deals with[31, 32, 33]. It scores each on eight things a developer with no client relationship can reach. The total sums the eight scores, so it runs from 0 to 16. A high total means the vendor opens to developers before any sale; a low total means access follows a relationship. So the total measures each vendor's selling model. Investment platforms cluster low because they gate. At Aladdin, as at Bloomberg, State Street, SimCorp, Clearwater and Arcesium, documentation, a sandbox and a first call come after a relationship exists. Data and cloud platforms sell to developers directly and cluster high. Among the investment platforms, only Studio offers an open-source SDK[21].

I pulled 128 recordings for this document[27, 28]. Five BlackRock speakers define Studio in them. Exhibit 8 lists each speaker with the title the recording gives.

Exhibit 8. Five BlackRock executives have defined Studio on the record

Speaker	Title, as the recording gives it	What they add to the definition	Recording
Dave Woodhead	Managing Director and Head of Engineering for Aladdin Studio	Gives the three-part definition quoted at the start of Part 1. Puts BlackRock's internal citizen developers at 3,000, a figure Goel also gives	Snowflake podcast, November 2025[5]
Richard Newman	General Manager, Aladdin Studio	Data Cloud is "part of Studio"; analytics APIs "releasing soon … all part of the Studio umbrella"	Never Done podcast, January 2025[13]
Diwakar Goel	Global Head of Data, Aladdin	Every transaction "via an event, via an API"; Data Cloud "within 15 minutes of latency"	Pensions webinar, 2025[24]
Kunal Khara	Managing Director and Global Head of Aladdin Product	Named "the Aladdin studio estate" as a 2024 focus, meaning programmatic access "at machine scale"	Awards interview, early 2024[39]
Jeff Miller	Managing Director, Global Head of Data Platform and Product Engineering	Data Cloud replaced "flat files … FTP and related transfers"	Snowflake video, undated[40]

Source: the recordings cited in the Recording column. Quotations are verbatim from the transcripts; three of the five are machine transcriptions, marked as such in the Sources section at the end of this document.

Four of the five describe Studio with the same three parts. Woodhead names them outright[5]. Newman calls Data Cloud "part of Studio"[13]. Goel describes events, APIs and a near-real-time data store[24]. Khara calls it programmatic access to data and reporting[39]. A 2026 job posting calls Studio "Aladdin's extensibility layer"[41]. The message is consistent across speakers and years, so BlackRock already has a positioning for Studio. Learning about it from outside takes effort. The catalog has to be unpacked from packages. The definitions have to be transcribed from recordings.

Exhibit 9. All four speakers name APIs, events and the Data Cloud as parts of Studio

Speaker, date	What they said	APIs and events	Data Cloud	Developer tools
Kunal Khara, early 2024	"More users are craving this ability to interact with our data, with their data, with reporting with dashboards on a programmatic basis"[39]	**Yes**	**Yes**	–
Richard Newman, January 2025	"The Aladdin data cloud … which is part of Studio"; "those analytic APIs … That's all part of the Studio umbrella"[13]	**Yes**	**Yes**	–
Diwakar Goel, 2025	"Every single transaction … via an event, via an API"; "a near real time data store"; exposing "the software and application that we're building"[24]	**Yes**	**Yes**	**Yes**
Dave Woodhead, November 2025	"It exposes everything Aladdin knows how to do as a set of APIs events. The Aladdin data cloud built on top of Snowflake … developer tools"[5]	**Yes**	**Yes**	**Yes**

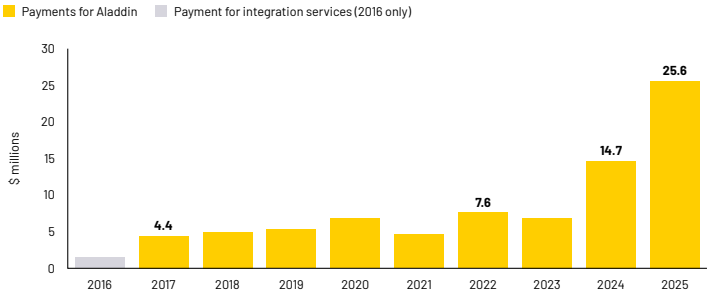
Source: the four recordings cited[39, 13, 24, 5]. Quotations are verbatim; Khara, Goel and Woodhead are machine or auto-caption transcriptions, marked as such in the Sources section at the end of this document. Yes means the speaker names that part; – means not. Only Goel and Woodhead name developer tools.

Part 2

1. The public record of clients using Aladdin can serve as Studio's proof

BlackRock's Studio page names no client building on Studio[11], and a full-text search of SEC EDGAR finds no filing that mentions Studio[42]. Proof that clients use Aladdin, though, is public. On BlackRock's video, Royal London's chief executive credits Aladdin's Snowflake implementation[43]. JPMorgan Chase's proxy statements report Aladdin payments of $4.4 million to $7.6 million a year from 2017 to 2023, then $14.7 million in 2024 and $25.6 million in 2025[2, 3].

Exhibit 10. JPMorgan Chase's payments for Aladdin rose from under $8 million a year to $25.6 million in 2025



Source: JPMorgan Chase proxy statements (DEF 14A) filed 2017 to 2026[2, 3]. The chart plots each payment in the year it was made. The grey 2016 bar is a payment for integration services; the figures in the text start with 2017. JPMorgan is also a custodian, so the payments may cover more than a client license. In 2016 it said it was connecting to Aladdin for custody clients[44]. That 2016 report is trade press, not a JPMorgan or BlackRock document.

In December 2025 a Janus Henderson engineer submitted two changes to the open-source SDK: URL rewriting and custom headers. Both are for firms that route Aladdin calls through an enterprise gateway. The BlackRock engineer who co-wrote the SDK's launch post merged them. The commits name a janushenderson.com address as the author[30, 45, 46, 47]. Janus Henderson's 10-K says that in the third quarter of 2025 the firm chose to move its investment management system to Aladdin, "a complex, multi-year initiative"[48]. Public buyers add a third kind of record: procurement notices.

Exhibit 11. Aladdin won the tenders of three public pension bodies

Buyer	Year	Outcome
UK Pension Protection Fund[49]	2025	Aladdin won both parts of the tender, at a price above the fund's own estimate
Nest (UK)[50]	2023	Aladdin won against six other bids
US Pension Benefit Guaranty Corporation[51]	2017 and 2023	Aladdin won in 2017 and again in 2023, at an unchanged price

Source: UK Find a Tender[49, 50]; USAspending.gov[51].

None of this proof names Studio, which matters less than it seems. Studio is sold for building custom applications on Aladdin, so a buyer wants to know that another institution built on the platform and stayed. Proof from one firm counts even when the buyer is a different kind of firm. Public pension funds, and firms whose filings or tenders already name BlackRock, are easier to name in public. So they are the natural first candidates for a named Studio story.

What this finding suggests about direction. A named Studio story can start with clients whose Aladdin use is already on the record.

2. BlackRock's growth story to investors runs through Studio, though it rarely says the name

BlackRock tells investors growth will come from two things: API calls, and the whole portfolio, public and private markets together. It projected at its 2025 Investor Day that API calls across BlackRock and Aladdin would grow 17x by 2030[1]. That was the fastest-growing measure on the slide, which was about keeping the cost of growth low. Model portfolios were projected at 4x, portfolios at 2x and trade allocations at 1.3x. The slide gives no starting number and does not say which products generate the API calls. Attributing them to Studio is my inference[1]. I make that inference because API use is the activity the Studio page describes[11]. No executive said "Studio" on any of the 26 earnings calls from the first quarter of 2020 to the second quarter of 2026[4]. Outside the calls, the only investor-facing mention I found is a single line on a 2023 Investor Day slide[52]. BlackRock's 10-K says technology services fees are generally set by the value of positions on the platform or at a fixed rate. They can also depend on subscriptions, go-lives and support. The 10-K does not list API calls among the fee terms it names[8, 1].

Exhibit 12. No BlackRock executive said "Studio" on any of 26 earnings calls, Q1 2020 to Q2 2026

Term	Mentions	Where it came up
Studio	**0**	**Never on a call. The only investor-facing mention found is one line on a 2023 Investor Day slide[52]**
Data Cloud	2	Q3 2022[53] and Q4 2024[54], where it was described as an add-on sold with Aladdin Enterprise
API	1	Q4 2021: "clients are really looking to use both data and APIs"[55]
Copilot	1	Q4 2023: "investments in Aladdin AI copilots"[56]
Citizen developer	0	Never
Agent	0	Never

Source: third-party transcripts of BlackRock earnings calls, Q1 2020 to Q2 2026[4]. My tally. The non-zero counts add up to about four mentions in six and a half years. A zero means the term appears in no transcript; the non-zero counts are approximate.

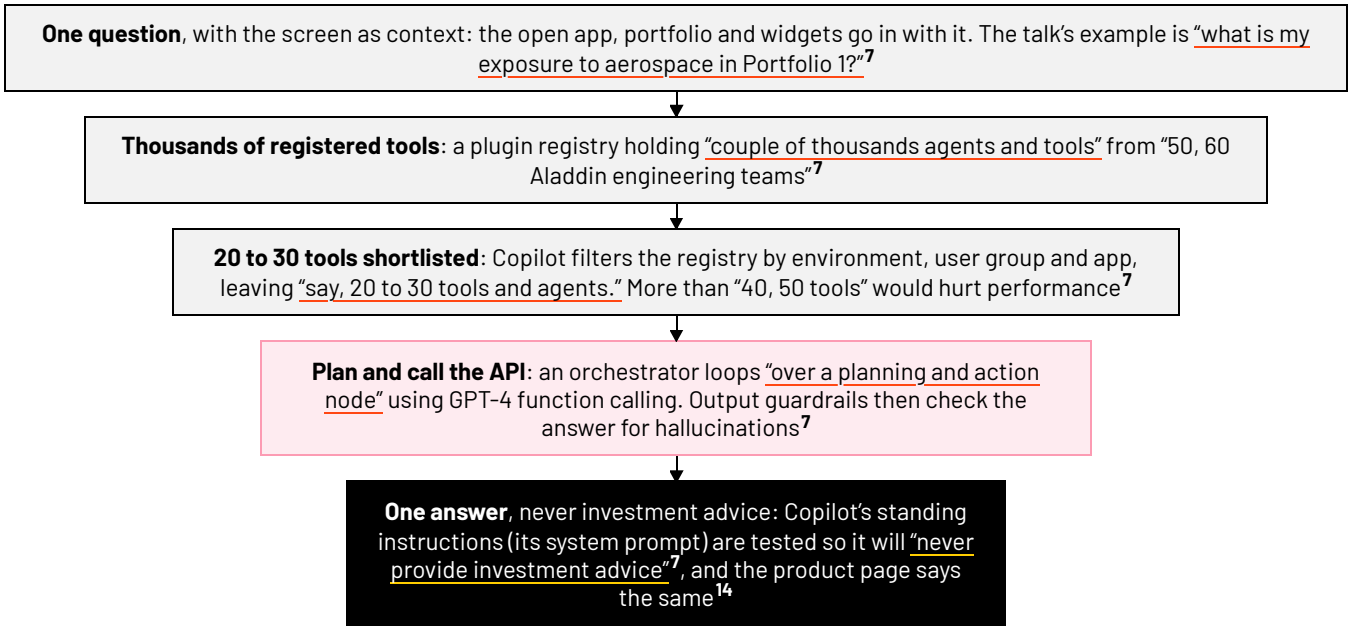
BlackRock bought eFront in 2019 and Preqin in 2025. In September 2025 its private markets team described the result on a client webinar[57]. Investors "now have access to over 15,000 fund investments within eFront Insight" for benchmarking. Preqin indices "are also available today in Aladdin Explore and our Aladdin Data Cloud capabilities". And "over 10 different transaction types" were added to Aladdin, covering commitments, fundings, paydowns and PIK, so private credit loans are captured natively. The team said those were designed with BlackRock's own professionals and "our new colleagues from HPS"[57]. Private credit analytics on Preqin followed in May 2026[10]. Newman, the Studio general manager, names eFront data and Preqin among the data being added to Data Cloud[13].

What this finding suggests about direction. BlackRock itself says growth will come from API calls, the fastest-growing measure it showed investors. The data it is adding, private markets and Preqin, arrives through Data Cloud and Explore. Both are Studio surfaces.

3. Aladdin's AI works only inside the login; data providers let outside AI tools reach their data

Aladdin Copilot draws on a registry of plugins, "couple of thousands agents and tools," built by Aladdin's engineering teams. The first way a team adds a tool is "to define a tool as kind of mapping one-to-one to an existing Aladdin API already out in production"[7]. So Copilot's tools are Studio's APIs. Microsoft's Adrian Crockett made the dependence plain on BlackRock's podcast: "There's no copilot without plug-ins"[58]. On the data side, BlackRock's AI product head says the team is making sure "the data model itself is structured for agentic use cases"[59].

Exhibit 13. Copilot answers a question by choosing from thousands of tools and calling production Aladdin APIs



Source: Rosales and Valdez at LangChain Interrupt 2025[7]; the Copilot page[14]. The tool counts are the speakers' own approximations; the talk is a machine transcription, marked as such in the Sources section.

Six data and cloud providers that Studio buyers also use offer a connector or an MCP server, and two system-of-record rivals have announced AI features. LSEG had 90 customers connected by April 2026, according to a secondary summary of its results slides[60, 61].

I found no public connector for Aladdin on BlackRock's pages or GitHub[11, 62]. One public hint is a job advert: a Forward Deploy Engineer posting for Aladdin Data names "Model Context Protocol (MCP), AI agents, and Copilot extensions"[63]. Exhibit 14 lists both comparisons a Studio buyer makes: the system-of-record rivals and the data vendors.

Exhibit 14. Of nine providers a Studio buyer compares, eight have announced AI features or AI access to their data

Provider	What is public	Receipt
System-of-record rivals		
SimCorp	Agent Launchpad, announced in 2026, is to offer prebuilt AI agents and let clients build their own on SimCorp One's data layer	SimCorp news[36]
Arcesium	Arcesium added AI features to Aquata and announced an AI platform	Arcesium press releases[64, 37]
Data and cloud providers		
FactSet	FactSet runs an MCP server for its data and calls it the first in its market	FactSet press release[65]
LSEG	LSEG has announced a collaboration with Anthropic and an MCP server. It had 90 customers connected by April 2026	LSEG press release[61]; Investing.com summary[60]
MSCI	MSCI offers "AI connectors" to its proprietary data	MSCI press release[38]
S&P Global	S&P Global added Credit Ratings to its AI Data Portal in September 2026	S&P Global press release[66]
Snowflake	Snowflake documents an MCP server for Cortex Agents	Snowflake documentation[67]
Databricks	Databricks documents managed MCP servers	Databricks documentation[68]
Aladdin	**None found. A Forward Deploy Engineer posting for Aladdin Data names "Model Context Protocol (MCP), AI agents, and Copilot extensions"**	**BlackRock Careers[63]**

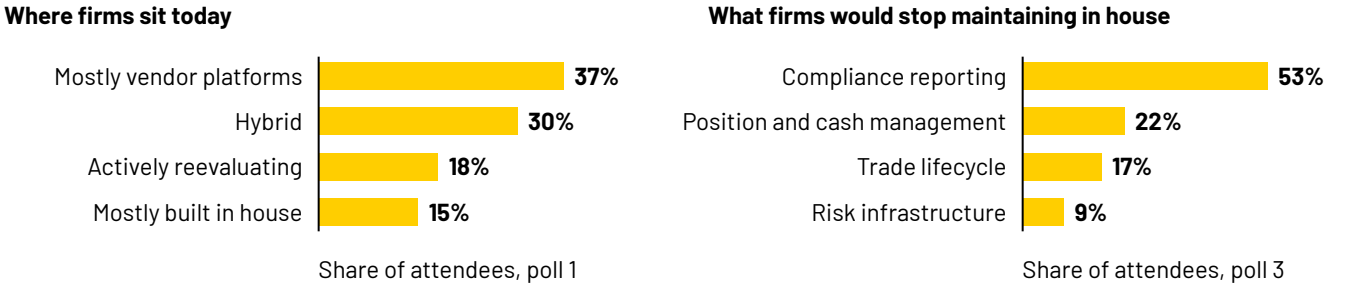
Source: the press releases, documentation and job posting in the Receipt column, as of October 2026. Aladdin has only a job advert that mentions MCP[63]. The LSEG customer count is from a secondary summary[60]. Among system-of-record rivals, only SimCorp and Arcesium have an AI announcement in my sources. State Street, Clearwater and Bloomberg have none, so they are not listed.

> **What this finding suggests about direction.** I would describe the Copilot plugin model publicly now: production Aladdin APIs, the same ones Studio exposes, each user's own permissions, and tested no-advice guardrails[7, 14]. That description answers three governance questions: who can call what, with which permissions, and under which guardrails.

4. Buyers at BlackRock's own webinar said they want a core platform plus their own builds

BlackRock ran a Build vs. Buy webinar for asset managers and polled the attendees. The first poll asked where firms sit today. 37 percent said they run "mostly vendor platforms," 30 percent run a "hybrid," 18 percent are "actively reevaluating," and 15 percent are "mostly built in house"[6]. The second poll asked what is driving the build-or-buy decision. "AI and data demands" led at 42 percent; cost and speed to market tied for second[6]. The third poll asked what they would stop maintaining in house. 53 percent chose compliance reporting[6].

Exhibit 15. Webinar attendees mostly run vendor or hybrid platforms and would stop maintaining compliance reporting in house first



Source: poll results read out on the Build vs. Buy webinar, from the replay's published captions[6].

> "What's the API suite that you have? Are you using connectors to Snowflake or to Databricks? And I think that that part of the RFP has become much more prominent."
>
> — Clark Schafer, Partner, Alpha FMC, on the Build vs. Buy webinar[6]

Alisha Sewdass, BlackRock's Head of Aladdin Solutions Engineering, Americas, gave BlackRock's side on the same webinar. She described the shift of the last two years. It is "to more of a modular approach where clients are looking for that backbone foundational data that supports both publics and privates workflows." That comes, she said, with "very, very robust APIs that manage the end to end life cycle of a transaction." Those APIs let clients build "their secret sauce rebalancing tools" on top[6]. On AI, she said, "you need that system of record that underpins anything that AI is built upon." She also said "the other layer that is almost equally important is a really defined system of work"[6].

Rivals are selling to the same buyer, the one who wants a core platform plus their own builds. SimCorp announced wins at AllianceBernstein in February 2026 and Pictet in May 2026. AllianceBernstein keeps its "specialized in-house technology," and Pictet connects its own tools to SimCorp One by API[69, 70]. BlackRock's own August 2026 insight page says the same: "Build vs buy is no longer a binary question"[71].

> **What this finding suggests about direction.** Buyers now ask in RFPs whether they can build on the platform. Studio is the right kind of answer.

Part 3

What the research suggests for this role's first six months

Exhibit 16. Five likely initial directions

Direction	What it involves	Owner	Measure of success
A named proof program	Shortlist clients already on the record: public funds whose tenders BlackRock won (the Pension Protection Fund[49], Nest[50], PBGC[51]), SEC filers that disclose Aladdin (JPMorgan Chase[3], Janus Henderson[48]), and Royal London, already on video[43]	Marketing	Number of named references in use by sales; number of deals in which one was cited
A one-page written definition of Studio	Turn the definition four speakers already give[5, 13, 24, 39] into one written page	Marketing	One page adopted; no deck or page contradicts it
An RFP-ready answer on the API suite	A document that answers the question buyers now ask[6]: what is your API suite? It lists each API domain with its specification count, operation count and status, plus the Snowflake connector and how clients build on top	Solutions engineering, with marketing	Time to answer the API question in an RFP; RFPs in which it is used
A public description of the Copilot plugin model	One page that says how Copilot's tools map to production APIs[7], what governance applies[14], and how clients will connect their own AI tools. Add the client AI-tool section when the work in the Forward Deploy Engineer posting[63] is ready	Product, with marketing	The description is public and dated; prospects stop asking about connectors in deal reviews
A prospect-facing summary of the public API catalog	One page listing the 11 API domains with the specification and operation counts and status of each, as in Exhibit 5[15], but without the specifications themselves	Marketing, with product	Number of meetings that skip the what-is-included discussion

About this document

This is an independent analysis compiled from public sources. The sources are BlackRock product pages, SEC filings, procurement notices, public code and packages on GitHub and PyPI, press releases, job postings, and transcripts of BlackRock recordings. BlackRock did not produce, review or endorse it.

AI agents pulled the pages, unpacked the packages, transcribed the recordings and drafted the text. I checked each claim against the document or recording it cites.

Facts are as of October 19, 2026, unless an exhibit gives another date. Underlined text links to the document behind each fact. Superscripts point to the Sources section, which follows this page and gives each source's grade (P, S or T), title, speaker and date.

The directions in Part 3 are my proposals, based on Part 1 and the findings in Part 2.

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Sources

Sources are numbered in the order they are first cited, then grouped into three grades, so the numbers within a group are not consecutive. P is a primary document. S is a BlackRock speaker on the record, with name and title as the recording gives them. T is a third-party report. For recordings, each entry gives the minute and second at which each quoted passage begins. "Machine transcription" means speech-to-text software run locally on the downloaded audio. "Auto-captions" means YouTube's captions. Both can mishear names and jargon. Inside quotations, the only correction made was to the spelling of proper names the captions got wrong.

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